

Executive Summary

Restaurant People Project

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Context

The McKinsey case presents an anonymous quick-service restaurant chain facing two underperformance gaps: 109% annual employee turnover and 43% customer satisfaction.

As a team, we chose to unanonymize the hypothetical restaurant and refer to it as “Chick-fil-A”. The objective was to improve service speed, customer satisfaction, and revenue growth per store without adding headcount.

Approach

Following the McKinsey People Analytics model, stakeholder meetings and restaurant observations narrowed 17 initial hypotheses to 4 testable propositions.

Nine data sources were integrated across ~280 stores and 10,000+ employees, including HRIS, transaction data, customer surveys, OHI surveys (2,055 respondents), Pymetrics psychometric assessments (654 employees), and Humanyze sociometric badges (8 stores).

After cleaning and feature engineering, regression models were built controlling for team size, time of day, and service mode.

Hypothesis

Finding	What the data showed	Recommendation
Hiring profile	Task-focused employees ("Taskmasters") outperform social ones — customers prioritise speed over warmth.	Hire for execution: redesign profiles around planning ability and attention control, not friendliness.
Shift length	Longer shifts correlated with slower service and lower satisfaction.	Build schedules around performance: reduce shift lengths, stagger staffing at peak hours.
Manager seniority	Tenure showed no significant relationship with speed, satisfaction, or revenue.	Measure managers by outcomes: introduce KPI scorecards to replace tenure-based evaluations.
Variable pay	Incentives had no significant effect on performance; operational discipline matters more.	Reward operational excellence by redesigning incentives around team-based operational KPIs.

Implementation Roadmap

Now	90 Days	6–12 Months
- Reduce shift lengths - Launch staffing pilots - Define manager KPI scorecards - Align leadership on findings	- Roll out KPI-based manager evaluation - Staggered scheduling across pilot stores - Begin hiring profile redesign	- Launch role-fit hiring assessments - Redesign incentive systems - Build an integrated people analytics infrastructure

Limitations & Measurement

Key limitations: performance reviews showed little differentiation (40% at top score); psychometric and badge data covered only a subset of stores and employees; franchise rollout must be incentive-based; psychometric screening should be piloted before scaling. Ethical risks include surveillance perception and potential assessment bias, as employee transparency and consent are essential.

Metrics to Measure Success

(through controlled pilot)

KPI	Current	Competitors	Target (12 months)
Customer satisfaction	43%	60–90%	Reach 60%+
Employee turnover rate	109%	30–75%	Below 80%
Speed of service	Baseline	—	Reduce via scheduling
Revenue growth per store	Baseline	Control delta	Positive vs. control